First 90 Days After Buying Insurance

Protect Your Policy From Day One

Most claims fail because of mistakes in the first 90 days. Don't let yours be one of them.

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Why the First 90 Days Matter

The first 90 days after buying an insurance policy are the most critical. This is when most policyholders make mistakes that can void their claims later. According to IRDAI data, a significant percentage of claim rejections are due to issues that originated in the first 90 days — non-disclosure, missing documents, and policy lapses.

CRITICAL STATISTIC

30-40% of all claim rejections are due to non-disclosure of pre-existing conditions. Most of these could have been avoided by properly disclosing at the time of buying the policy.

Day 1-7: Immediate Actions

Day 1: Verify Your Policy Document

- Check that your name, date of birth, and personal details are correct
- Verify the sum assured, premium amount, and policy term
- Check that all declared pre-existing conditions are recorded
- Verify the nominee details
- Check the policy start date and premium due dates

If you find any errors, contact the insurer IMMEDIATELY. Errors in the policy document can lead to claim rejection later.

Day 2-3: Set Up Premium Payment

- Set up auto-debit (ECS/NACH) for premium payments
- Mark all premium due dates in your calendar
- Set reminders 7 days before each due date
- Keep a separate bank account for insurance premiums if possible

Day 4-5: Organize Your Documents

- Create a dedicated folder (physical and digital) for insurance documents
- Scan and save: policy document, premium receipts, medical reports
- Share policy details with your spouse/nominee
- Store digital copies in cloud storage (Google Drive, Dropbox)

Day 6-7: Understand Your Policy

- Read the complete policy document, including all terms and conditions
- Note down all exclusions (what's NOT covered)
- Note down waiting periods for specific conditions
- Save the insurer's customer service number and claims helpline
- Download the insurer's mobile app (if available)

Day 8-30: Free Look Period

You have a 15-day free-look period (30 days for online policies) from the date of receiving the policy document. During this period, you can cancel the policy for a full refund if you find that the terms don't match what was promised by the agent.

- Compare the policy document with what the agent promised
- Check if all riders and add-ons you requested are included
- Verify the premium amount matches what you agreed to
- If anything is wrong, cancel within the free-look period for full refund
- Send cancellation request by registered post or email (keep proof)

Day 31-60: Waiting Period Begins

Most policies have waiting periods during which certain claims cannot be made. Understanding these waiting periods is crucial to avoid claim rejection.

Health Insurance Waiting Periods

- Initial waiting period: 30 days (no claims except accidents)
- Pre-existing diseases: 2-4 years (varies by insurer)
- Specific diseases: 2 years (hernia, cataract, joint replacement, etc.)
- Maternity cover: 2-9 years (varies widely)

Life Insurance Waiting Periods

- Suicide clause: 1 year (claim not payable if suicide within 1 year)
- Accidental death benefit: Usually no waiting period
- Critical illness rider: 90 days

Day 61-90: Consolidation

Update Your Nomination

- Ensure nomination is in place for life insurance policies
- Update nominee details if there have been changes (marriage, birth)
- For joint policies, consider assigning the policy to the nominee

Inform Your Family

- Tell your spouse/parents about the policy
- Share the policy document location (physical and digital)
- Share the insurer's claims helpline number
- Explain how to file a claim

Schedule Your First Policy Review

- After 90 days, review if the policy still meets your needs
- Check if your income or family situation has changed
- Consider if you need additional coverage
- Contact Insurance Support for a free policy review

Common Mistakes to Avoid

- Not reading the policy document thoroughly
- Not disclosing pre-existing conditions (even minor ones)
- Missing premium payments (even by one day can cause lapse)
- Not updating nominee details after life events
- Not keeping copies of all documents

- Not informing family members about the policy
- Waiting too long to file a claim
- Not following up on claim status regularly

Checklist: First 90 Days

- [ ] Policy document received and verified
- [ ] All personal details checked and correct
- [ ] Pre-existing conditions properly declared
- [ ] Nominee details updated
- [ ] Premium auto-debit set up
- [ ] Calendar reminders set for all due dates
- [ ] Documents organized (physical + digital)
- [ ] Family members informed about policy
- [ ] Insurer's claims helpline saved in phone
- [ ] Free-look period cancellation deadline noted
- [ ] Waiting periods noted for future reference
- [ ] First policy review scheduled

Need Help With Your New Policy?

Our experts can review your new policy, explain the terms in simple language, and ensure you're fully protected. Free consultation for new policyholders.

Contact Insurance Support

Call/WhatsApp: +91-9986634506

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